



E Y E S S P I E S

“Every move you make, I’ll be watching you”...catchy lyrics from the music group, the Police, but what if technology made it possible for someone to be watching you without your ever knowing it?

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The cell phone was the means by which Neo’s friends watched over him—every step of the way—in *The Matrix*. And in *Charlie’s Angels*, all the bad guys had to do was listen to the cell phone signals and use the global positioning system to track down the elusive Charlie. Now if someone were to tell you that this could happen in real life, you’d probably dismiss it as heightened imagination laced with technology, right?

Well, that’s where you are wrong. Spying has become more complex and widespread than the old-fashioned way of planting bugs or tapping phone lines.

How safe are you being ‘mobile’?

Wireless technology offers several advantages, and the most prominent advantage is the mobility it confers on you even as you stay connected to the communication and information sources.

The ubiquity of mobile devices such as mobile phones, PDAs vouches for this.

However, wireless devices also make you vulnerable as far as privacy is concerned. It’s very easy for someone to spy on the conversations you have on your mobile. In fact, for someone who knows how, it’s even easier than tapping into a landline. The threat of hacking into wireless networks is so widespread that the term ‘whacking’ been coined to represent it (see box, ‘*The Ghosts in my Mobile*’ to find out how and where security breaches take place).

The basic mode of hacking into wireless networks is almost the same, irrespective of whether it is a cellular network or a corporate wireless network. The basic apparatus that a wireless hacker (or whacker) uses consists of a transmitter/receiver to tune into the wireless network. The transmitter/receiver is connected to an antenna and a PC, which is loaded with